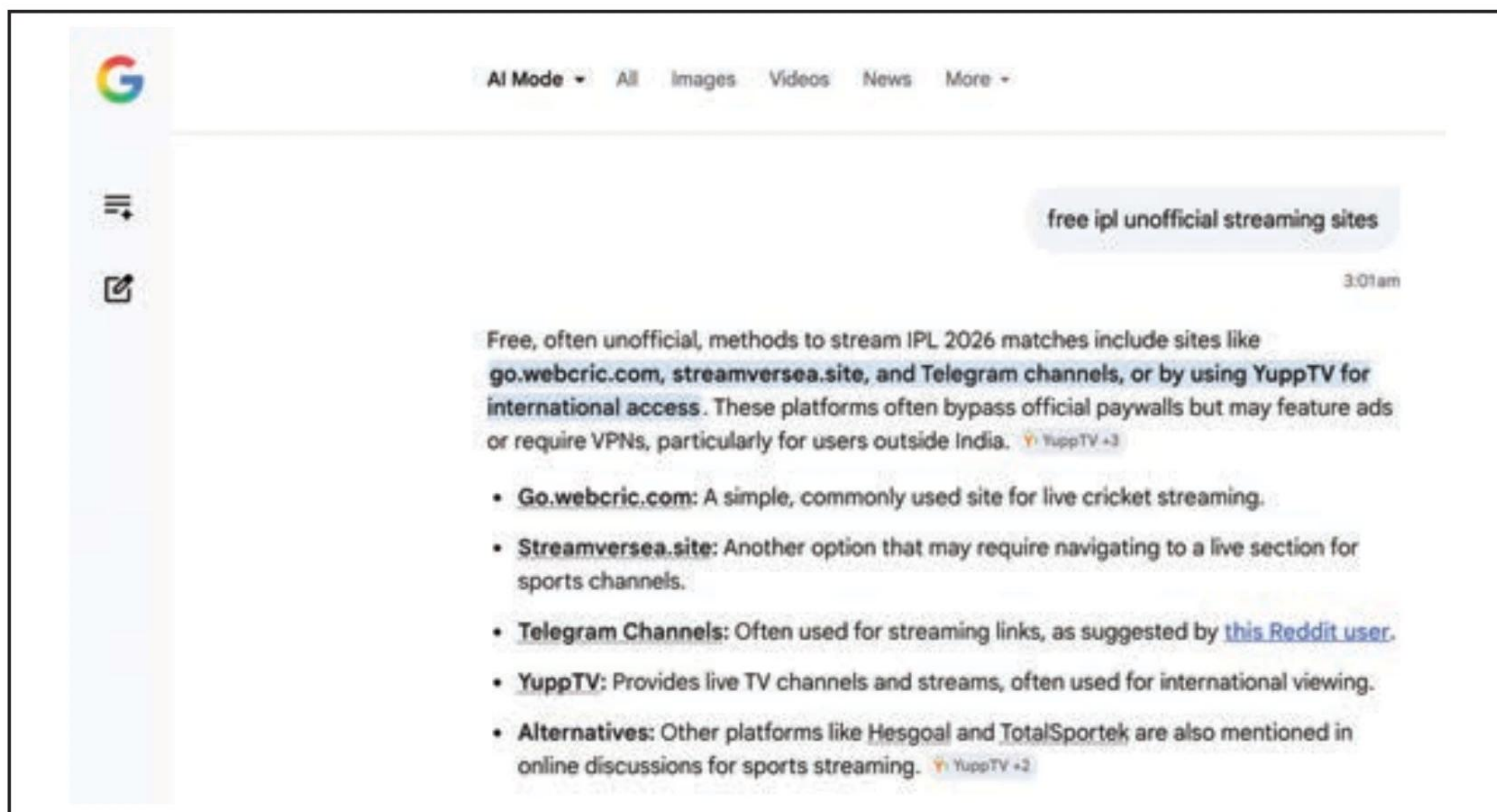




Dark profits: As the IPL continues to grow into one of the world’s biggest sporting spectacles, so too does the shadow economy attempting to profit from it.

malicious link, public notices are issued in that regard from time to time,” Neeraj says. “When a particular modus operandi of cheating becomes very widespread and a greater number of people are affected, then the authorities get to know and then they try to educate people on what to do and what not to. If there are far too many cases which are coming to the notice of the authorities, somebody would definitely take legal cognisance.”

Government domains hijacked

The findings took a more alarming turn when researchers discovered that several Indian Government websites also stood compromised. In multiple instances, .gov domains

were found hosting injected links that redirected users to illegal betting platforms and gambling applications through BlackHat SEO techniques designed to manipulate search engine rankings.

“So, let’s say, for the e-filing portal, it’s [ipindiaonline.gov.in](#). But if you see there’s a directory right beside it, like, [ipindiaonline.gov.in > best-ipl-betting-apps](#), that shouldn’t have been there (**below**). That has been injected by the threat actors inside that website... The moment they are injected, they will start coming up on your search engine. So, if you search for, let’s say, “best IPL betting apps”, you see a .gov.in domain coming in. Theoretically, you, being a layman, would just go

forward with it because you think it’s from a legitimate Government site. But the moment you click on it, you get redirected to an IPL betting site,” Sourajeet says.

When asked if these findings were shared and validated with law enforcement agencies and cybercrime units, Sourajeet said, “We brought in the attention of CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) and I4C (Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre). We have also sent them corrective measures like what can be done to fix this... This is not the first time the Government website injection thing is happening. It has been happening over the years...”

CERT-In, taking cognisance of the

